

Khizar Ul Islam

Junior SOC Analyst | Blue Team Fundamentals | Security Monitoring

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SUMMARY

Software Engineering graduate with hands-on experience as a SOC Analyst Intern, deploying and administering Wazuh SIEM infrastructure, monitoring endpoints for threats, investigating multi-vector attack simulations, and mapping detections to MITRE ATT&CK. Brings practical experience in incident response, log correlation, and alert triage, combined with a red-team foundation in reconnaissance, vulnerability assessment, and exploitation using Metasploit and msfvenom. Skilled in translating technical findings into clear security documentation. Seeking to grow into a full-time SOC Analyst or Junior Security Engineer role.

EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst Intern

Axeronix Technology

Jul 2026 – Present

Islamabad, Pakistan

- Configure and administer a single-node Wazuh SIEM (manager, indexer, dashboard) on Ubuntu Server, enrolling Windows 11 endpoints and forwarding Security/Sysmon event channels to enable centralized threat monitoring.
- Simulate and investigate multi-vector attacks (network reconnaissance, SMB brute-force, encoded PowerShell execution), triaging 2,300+ alerts and correlating IOCs to source hosts across 10+ MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Author professional SOC incident and detection-mapping reports and execute CIS benchmark compliance scans (480+ controls), translating findings into actionable hardening recommendations.

Red Team OJT Trainee

NAVTTTC and VirtualSoft Technology

Jun 2026

Islamabad, Pakistan

- Completed a 12-day on-site Red Team training program, executing the full attack lifecycle from reconnaissance through exploitation against lab and cloud-hosted targets.
- Performed OSINT reconnaissance with Shodan and network scanning/enumeration with Nmap; identified and exploited 5+ vulnerabilities using Metasploit Framework and custom msfvenom payloads on TryHackMe machines.
- Documented a 20+ page penetration test report for a vulnerable API target, detailing methodology, exploitation steps, and remediation recommendations.

Game Developer Intern

Robotics World

Jul 2025 – Sep 2025

Abbottabad, Pakistan

- Designed and implemented interactive game mechanics and core gameplay systems in Unity using C#, applying object-oriented design principles to build clean, reusable, and debuggable code.
- Created original visual assets aligned to gameplay requirements, working closely with the design team to deliver polished features end-to-end.

Web Developer Intern

Checkmates Technology

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Abbottabad, Pakistan

- Built and styled front-end web pages using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, developing a working understanding of client-side request flow and browser rendering behavior.
- Collaborated within a Git-based, version-controlled development workflow, maintaining clean project structure and clear technical documentation across the codebase.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

SZABIST

Feb 2021 – Feb 2025

Islamabad

Relevant Coursework: Computer Networks, Network Security, Operating Systems, Database Systems, Cybersecurity

Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)

NAVTTTC Government-Sponsored On-Site Training Program

Feb 2026 – Jun 2026

Core domains: Footprinting & Reconnaissance, Network Scanning & Enumeration, Vulnerability Analysis, System Hacking, Packet Sniffing & Traffic Analysis

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

SIEM Deployment — Wazuh and ELK

- Deployed a single-node Wazuh SIEM stack (manager, indexer, dashboard) and a single-node Elastic Stack (ELK) on Ubuntu Server using VMware, establishing hands-on proficiency with two industry-standard SIEM platforms.
- Configured Wazuh and Elastic agents on Windows endpoints to forward logs for centralized monitoring, and authored professional deployment guides documenting both builds end-to-end.

Endpoint Detection by Wazuh

- Enrolled and configured Windows 11 endpoints as Wazuh agents, enabling Security and Sysmon event channel forwarding to strengthen endpoint visibility.
- Audited enrolled endpoints against 480+ CIS security benchmark controls and implemented manual hardening based on findings.

Log Monitoring by Wazuh

- Analyzed authentication, process-execution, and system logs in the Wazuh dashboard to identify anomalous activity and correlate events across 3+ log sources.
- Traced Windows Event IDs (logon failures, process creation) through to Wazuh-generated alerts, validating end-to-end log pipeline integrity.

Multi-Vector Attack Investigation Lab

- Executed a controlled multi-vector attack simulation from a Kali Linux VM against a monitored Windows 11 host, combining 3 distinct attack vectors: network reconnaissance, SMB brute-force, and base64-encoded PowerShell execution.
- Investigated the resulting Wazuh alerts, correlating source IPs and process data to confirm detections, and authored a professional SOC incident report with MITRE ATT&CK mapping (T1059.001, T1110, T1087), including a Critical-severity alert traced to a benign PowerShell artifact rather than an independent compromise.
- Identified and documented a genuine detection gap for raw network reconnaissance in the default Wazuh ruleset, recommending IDS integration as remediation.

MITRE ATT&CK Detection-Mapping Report Series

- Authored a portfolio of MITRE ATT&CK mapping reports, including a 10-technique ransomware (LockBit 3.0) mapping and a 20-technique detection-mapping report with PowerShell abuse and DLL sideloading case studies.
- Compiled a full incident-response report simulating a ransomware attack chain from initial phishing access through impact.

TryHackMe Practical Labs

- Finished 20+ TryHackMe rooms covering reconnaissance, enumeration, exploitation, and traffic analysis using Kali Linux, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, and Shodan.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM & Monitoring: Wazuh (deployment & administration), Log Correlation & Analysis, Windows Event Log Analysis, Alert Triage, IOC Analysis, MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Security Operations: Incident Response, Threat Detection & Analysis, Endpoint Monitoring, Vulnerability Management

Security Tools: Nmap, Metasploit Framework, msfvenom, Wireshark, Shodan, Hashcat

Networking: TCP/IP, OSI Model, Subnetting, VLAN Basics, Firewall Configuration, Packet Capture & Analysis

Penetration Testing: Reconnaissance & OSINT, Network Scanning & Enumeration, Vulnerability Assessment, Exploitation Basics, Cloud Infrastructure Pentesting

Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Windows Server 2019, Windows 10/11, Ubuntu Server

Programming/Scripting: C#, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Documentation: Incident Reporting, Penetration Test Report Writing, Technical Documentation